

The Stafford Air & Space Museum is located in Weatherford, Oklahoma, United States. The museum, named after NASA astronaut and Weatherford native Thomas P. Stafford, became a Smithsonian Affiliate in June 2010.

The museum's displays include Stafford's Apollo 10 spacesuit, the Gemini 6A spacecraft he piloted in 1965, artifacts from the Space Shuttle program, the Hubble Space Telescope, the Mir Space Station, a Moon rock, a Titan II missile, a Mark 6 re-entry vehicle, and a collection of over 20 historic aircraft.

The museum is located at the Thomas P. Stafford Airport.

Name

The museum is named for astronaut and flight pioneer Lt. Gen. Thomas P. Stafford, a native of Weatherford and one of only 24 people to have traveled to the Moon. Graduating from the U.S. Naval Academy, Stafford is a recipient of the Congressional Space Medal of Honor. A veteran of four space flights, he piloted Gemini 6A in 1965, commanded Gemini 9A in 1966, flew the 1969 Moon-orbiting mission Apollo 10, and commanded the American capsule of the 1975 Apollo–Soyuz Test Project.

History

The museum opened in 1983 in two rooms at the Weatherford airport. By 2006, it had expanded to four buildings.

The museum purchased a Space Shuttle simulator in 2016. It began fundraising for an 18,000 sq ft (1,700 m²) expansion in 2017.

Exhibits

The center boasts one of the few Titan II launch vehicles on display. The huge rocket body spans the back of a display gallery from one side of the building to the other. Numerous items

acquired from the Smithsonian and on display include: a Gemini flight suit, space food, survival items flown to the Moon on Apollo 11, and the flight pressure suit Stafford wore on Apollo 10, the first flight of the Apollo Lunar Module which orbited the Moon.

The hatch through which U.S. astronauts and Russian cosmonauts docked and greeted each other in space during the 1975 Apollo–Soyuz mission is on display in the museum. Stafford is pictured reaching through the hatch, shaking hands with Russian cosmonaut Alexei Leonov. The uniforms that the two astronauts were wearing at the time are also on display.

Other exhibits include retired aircraft, such as a Russian MiG-21R and a F-16. Full-size replicas displayed include the Wright Flyer, Spirit of St. Louis, Apollo Command Module, and Gemini spacecraft. The museum also features the Rose & Tom Luczo Educational Center, which includes a flight simulation computer lab, a kids' library, and a Talon A3 Motion-Based Flight Simulator that runs X-Plane 11 and Microsoft Flight Simulator X. Also on display is a TP-82 Cosmonaut survival pistol given to Stafford by Leonov.

As of March 5, 2018, the museum has acquired a Fairchild Republic A-10 Thunderbolt II, also known as the "Warthog," which is on display outside the museum. In July 2018, the Gemini 6A spacecraft was moved to the museum.

Early aviation

Wright Flyer (full-scale, flyable replica)

Blériot XI (full-scale replica)

Curtiss Pusher (full-scale, flyable replica)

Sopwith Pup (full-scale replica)

Spirit of St. Louis (full-scale replica)

Early rocketry

Goddard rocket (full-scale replica)

V-2 rocket engine

Sputnik 1 (full-scale replica)

Explorer 1 (full-scale replica)

Mercury, Gemini, and Apollo programs

Lunar Sample collected by Gene Cernan on Apollo 17

Congressional Space Medal of Honor presented to Thomas P. Stafford in 1993

Gemini 6A spacecraft

Gen. Stafford's Gemini space suit

Apollo 10 space suit

Lunar Module Checklist

Apollo–Soyuz Docking Ring

Mission Control console from Johnson Space Center (actual used artifact)

F-1 rocket engine

J-2 rocket engine

Titan II rocket

Full scale Apollo Lunar Module replica

Apollo Command and Service Module (full-scale replica)

Gemini spacecraft (full-scale replica)

1/72 scale models of all of the man-rated rockets of the "Space Race"

Astronaut Maneuvering Unit model

Modern space and aviation

Space Shuttle main engine

Shuttle solid rocket booster segment

Mark 6 nuclear warhead

1/15th scale Hubble Space Telescope

Rocket "Crawler Shoe"

Bell X-1 (full-scale replica)

F-86 "Sabre" fighter

MiG-21R "Fishbed" fighter

T-38 "Talon" trainer

T-33 trainer

B61 thermonuclear bomb

F-16 "Fighting Falcon"

F-104 "Starfighter"

F-4 Phantom

A-10 Thunderbolt II "Warthog"

References

External links

Museum website

Stafford Air & Space Museum info, photos and videos on TravelOK.com Official travel and tourism website for the State of Oklahoma